CATERPILLAR®

DEALER BEST PRACTICE SERIES

Component Rebuild History Tracking and Tagging

Application | Maintenance | Site Management | **Component Rebuild** | Component Life Management | Safety | MARC Management

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1.0 Introduction

When a major component is coming to the CRC for a rebuild, information on repair / rebuild history and total hours on the component must be readily available. This information is to help make rebuild decisions regarding the current rebuild.

Quick assess to history and hours information allows the CRC to determine the salvage work which may be required, critical parts which may need to be replaced or salvaged, or whether replacing the component with a Reman component should be considered.

This Best Practice is a major component marking procedure for tracking component hours and history information.

2.0 Best Practice Description

The objective of this Best Practices is to create a process where the CRC has easy access to component history information. As example, it may save a lot of time and effort if the CRC knows in advance that an engine coming in has 55,000 total hours, has been rebuilt three times, and the block has been machined twice and is at minimum deck height.

Several dealers have developed an identification tag that is permanently installed on a major component each time the component is rebuilt. The tag is stenciled with key information necessary for future rebuilds on that component.

Key information required needs to be determined by the dealer. Often included are:

- Component Serial Number
- Component Arrangement
- Performance Spec
- Test Document Number
- Work Order Number / Date
- Hours on current rebuild

Other information, such as customer name, machine model, etc may also be included.

If a component does not have a factory serial number, such as final drive, then the dealer assigns a serial number to the component.

Example from Wyoming Machinery Co.

Example from C. I. Walker Machinery Co.

3.0 Implementation Steps

This Best Practice is easy to replicate and involves minimal cost.

Steps Include;

- Determine what information needs to be on an ID tag.
- Design tags
- Determine a standard mounting location for common machine components.
- Assign responsibility for stenciling and installing tags on components.
- To start the program, it would be necessary to gather past history of components coming into the shop and make sure that previous rebuild information is marked on the tag.

4.0 Benefits

- Quick assess to history and hours information.
- Better repair and reuse / salvage decisions.

5.0 Resources Required

- Minimal cost of tags and stencil equipment.

6.0 Supporting Attachments / References

7.0 Related Best Practices

C175 ID Tags for Engines that Require Thicker Integral Seals 1606-4.01-1439

8.0 Acknowledgements

Photos from Wyoming Machinery Company and C. I. Walker Machinery Co.

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